January 2026
Research Ethics Application Checklist

All sections of the form should be completed. You must append, at the end of this form, all of the materials for your project (including a consent for participation). The staff member reviewing this form needs to see full details of what your participants will experience (includes access to archive materials). In completing this form, you must follow the guidance provided by your subject area. Some important information to note.

- This form shall be submitted via the research ethics committee ethics applicati form;
- The application shall be made one month in advance before the official start do of your research project;
- The period of review shall take between 2 weeks and 1 month depending on t complexities of your research;
- Do not reach out to individual committee members while you await the outcome your application;
- Your application will only start going through the review process if you have linked the form your research proposal and your data collection instruments - with t consent Form on the first page of the instruments;
- You and your supervisor need to sign off on the application with electror signatures.

PART A: Summary (Box A7 is restricted to keep this section concise).

A1. Campus/Hub/Organisation:	
A2. Faculty/Department	
A3. Project Title:	
A4. Student/Principal Researcher's Name	
A5. Email address: (institutional email ONLY)	
A6. Supervisor's Name:	

Links to Documents:

1. Research Proposal - [insert link]
2. Data Collection Instrument - [insert link]
3. Consent Form - customised - [insert link] - template

A7. Project Summary: What are you intending to do? Be as explicit as possible about the rationale behind your proposed study,

1. its aims,
2. the methods to be used,
3. including detail of your intended procedure and tasks,
4. participant sample and recruitment method,
5. and location in which the research will take place.

For Software Engineering projects, briefly describe:

a) Clearly state the nature of the software being developed (e.g., full-stack web application, mobile application, machine learning model, AR/VR simulation, low-level system utility or a combination of these specialities).
b) data sources, algorithm or code to be reused
c) Provide a high-level overview of how users are expected to interact with the software and the types of data that might be collected, even if detailed plans will emerge later.

respond to A7 here

Part B: Assessment of Risk *Does your proposed research study involve any of the following? (Click the appropriate answer box. Striking it out means that is your choice of the options)*	
B1. My Research involves vulnerable groups (such as children aged 16 and under; those lacking capacity; or individuals in a dependent or unequal relationship)	☐ YES ☐ NO
B2. Research involves sensitive topics (such as participants' sexual behaviour; their legal or political behaviour; their experience of violence; their gender or ethnic status)	☐ YES ☐ NO
B3. Research involves a significant element of deception (i.e. beyond the withholding of the research hypotheses where this is necessary for methodological reasons)	☐ YES ☐ NO
B4. Research involves access to records of personal or confidential information (including genetic or other biological information)	☐ YES ☐ NO
B5. Research involves access to potentially sensitive data through third parties (such as organisational or employee data)	☐ YES ☐ NO
B5.1 Research involve collecting, storing, or processing Personally Identifiable Information (PII) or other sensitive user data (e.g., health, financial, behavioural)?	☐ YES ☐ NO
B5.2 Research project utilises third-party services (e.g., cloud hosting, databases, analytics platforms, APIs)	☐ YES ☐ NO
B6. Research that could induce psychological stress, anxiety or humiliation or cause more than minimal pain (e.g. repetitive or prolonged testing)	☐ YES ☐ NO
B7. Research that may place the researcher at risk of psychological or physical harm	☐ YES ☐ NO
B8. Research that is conducted off-campus (e.g. in an archive or library, at a community centre, at a constituency office, during filming, photography, recording or interviewing etc.)	☐ YES ☐ NO
B9. Research involving invasive interventions (such as the administration of drugs or other substances, vigorous physical exercise or techniques such as hypnotherapy) that would not usually be encountered during everyday life	☐ YES ☐ NO
B10. Research that may have an adverse impact on employment or social standing (e.g. discussion of an employer, discussion of commercially sensitive information)	☐ YES ☐ NO
B11. Research that may lead to 'labelling' either by the researcher (e.g. categorisation) or by the participant (e.g. 'I am stupid', 'I am not normal')	☐ YES ☐ NO
B12. Research that involves the collection of human tissue, blood or other biological samples	☐ YES ☐ NO
B13. Research using procedures that may interact with a pre-existing medical condition in a participant (e.g., a heart disorder in physical exercise studies, allergies in taste studies, epilepsy in computer-based studies).	☐ YES ☐ NO
B14. Research requiring the use of potentially hazardous equipment or environments.	☐ YES ☐ NO
B15. Research requiring ethical approval from another source (e.g. research in the prisons).	☐ YES ☐ NO
B16. Research requiring permissions from another source (e.g. schools or businesses/organisations, a copyright holder, commercial sources).	☐ YES ☐ NO
B17. Research involves the development or use of software that collects or processes personal data	☐ YES ☐ NO

If you have any queries about the ethics application process or the outcomes, please contact the Research/Capstone Lead of your Faculty (or appointed representative) or the University's Research Ethics Committee. Research Ethics

B18. Research involves the use of artificial intelligence/machine learning models.	☐ YES ☐ NO
B19. Research uses external datasets	☐ YES ☐ NO
B20. Research involves reusing external code or datasets.	☐ YES ☐ NO
B21. Research involves human-computer interaction (e.g., user testing).	☐ YES ☐ NO

If you answered 'Yes' to any of the above (Section B), please explain how you will ensure the ethical conduct of the research.
If you answered 'Yes' to B17, B18, B19, B20, and B21, give explanations (e.g., for how data is secured, measures to address bias, licenses and attribution, consent process).

If applicable, explain what steps you will be taking to ensure you are appropriately skilled to collect data from special populations or to collect data on sensitive issues. You must demonstrate here that you have anticipated and planned for any difficulties that may arise, including consideration of any personal risk that the researcher may be exposed to (including working off-site).

if you answered "yes" to any question in section B"Assessment of risk" then respond here - in this box.

Indicate the number (e.g. B16) then explain how you will ensure ethical conduct as per the specific question:

Example:
B16 - ethical conduct will be maintained by....

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PART C: Data Management and Storage

During Data Collection

All paper forms involving personal data (such as consent forms) should immediately be scanned and the electronic files should be stored on your personal Google Drive at African Leadership University as an electronic backup. For coding situations, resort to private, university-sanctioned version control repositories (e.g., private GitHub or GitLab instances) with appropriate access controls for storing and managing source code. You should not give permission for anyone else to view these files other than your supervisor (who is part of the research team). Under no circumstances should data be stored on unencrypted USB memory sticks or hard drives. In the event of the hardware failing or theft, this means that you will lose the data (which means that people have given their time for nothing, which is unethical). Participants should be allocated a Unique Identifier (ID) code prior to any data collection and only this ID (not personal information such as name, address - as you have been taught in your Research Symposium Classes) should be recorded on any data collection forms (e.g. interviews, questionnaires, computer tasks). If qualitative data such as focus group recordings are going to be transcribed then this should be done as soon as possible, then the original recording deleted (upon supervisor confirmation) and the transcriptions pseudo-anonymised to remove personal identifying information (names) - especially for sensitive research. If they are not going to be transcribed then data reduction and analysis should be done as soon as possible, pseudo-anonymised, then the recordings should be destroyed.

Data Storage and Retention

All digital materials relating to this study, including data, recordings and signed consent forms, will be stored on your personal google drive at African Leadership University for a period of 3 months following your graduation and will then be securely destroyed.

PART D: Final checklist and declaration

D1. In completing this form, have you followed the guidance provided by your subject area? ☐ YES ☐ NO
D2. Have you included any adverts or letters by which you mean to recruit participants? ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D3. Will the timescales within which participants may withdraw from the study (including their data) clear and specific, and explained to participants? ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D4. Have you made the mechanisms for withdrawing from the study clear to participants, including specifying a point after which it will not be possible to withdraw data? ☐ YES ☐ NO

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☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D5. Have you included your Consent Form? (Please note: Consent Forms are not required for purely postal or internet-based questionnaire studies where completion of the questionnaire itself denotes participant consent). ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D6. Have you made it clear to participants that the research is being undertaken with supervision for an undergraduate project at African Leadership University? ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D7. You will provide participants with your supervisor's name and contact details - in case they need to reach out for confirmation or have any future queries? ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D8. You will provide participants with your name and contact details (i.e. your University email address)? ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D9. Have you included copies of all measures, tests, inventories, questionnaires, interview questions and research proposal you intend to use in the course of your research in your application? ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D10. Have you included approval obtained from other Research Ethics Committees or permissions from other organisations (if applicable)? ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D11. Have you made it clear to participants that any personal or sensitive data and related materials will be anonymised and stored securely at ALU for a period of 1 year after completion of the study? ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D12. Will you make it clear who will have access to the raw and summarised data? ☐ YES ☐ NO
D13. Will you make it clear to participants that anonymised data may form part of a publication written by the researcher and/or their supervisor?

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☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D14. Have you checked all participant materials to ensure that there are no spelling or grammatical errors? ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D15. I confirm that participants will not be subjected to any undue or disproportionate incentives to participate in the proposed study. ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D16. Have you identified all third-party software, libraries, APIs, or Open-Source Software to be used, verified their licenses, and outlined how you will ensure compliance with all license terms ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D17. For software projects: Have you included a plan for secure handling of user data (if any) during testing? ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D18. For software projects: If using external code, have you checked the licenses and provided proper attribution? ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE
D19. For software projects: If using ML models and external datasets, have you considered potential biases, outlined steps to mitigate such bias, and considered the fairness and accountability of your model and documented them? ☐ YES ☐ NO ☐ NOT APPLICABLE

Note that in submitting this form, you are agreeing to comply with the following procedures. Failure to adhere to this process will constitute a breach of ethical requirements and may result in your failing the module or facing disciplinary action:

1. Only you and your supervisor(s) may have access to the data.
2. Prior to commencing data analysis, you must show your supervisor ALL of your collected data is stored electronically on Google Drive (e.g. questionnaires, response sheets, recordings of interviews, or, for computer-based studies, all of the individual participant data files) so that it can be verified that the data have been collected.
3. Once data analysis has been completed, you must give your supervisor all of the collected data, as described in 2. This will be stored securely and retained for 3

months after graduation. Any other copies of data that the student/lead investigator(s) may have MUST be destroyed securely once the report has been submitted.

4. Each Faculty must appoint a member of academic staff to the role of Data Management for undergraduate projects with responsibility for secure storage and destruction of data 3 months to a year after graduation

Supervisor Authorisation

Your application for research ethics review and clearance will NOT be reviewed by the research ethics committee if your supervisor has not authorised and signed this form.

TO BE COMPLETED BY THE STUDY SUPERVISOR

I confirm that the student/lead investigator has had appropriate health and safety training.

- ☐ YES
- ☐ NO
- ☐ N/A

I confirm that I have checked the form and the related materials and agree that, in addition to general ethical issues, the matters listed above have been specifically addressed.

- ☐ YES
- ☐ NO

Do not submit this form without your supervisor's approval and signature!

Signature of Study Supervisor(s):

Name(s):

Signature of Student(s)/lead investigator(s):

Name(s):

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